



FAST FACTS

HEALTHCARE

1:847

The rural doctor-patient ratio according to the Ministry of Health and Family Welfare

71%

Share of NCDs in all deaths, according to the Indian Council of Medical Research

57.8%

Out-of-pocket healthcare expenditure in India as proportion of total health expenditure, per World Bank

PHARMACEUTICALS

1.2%

R&D investment as a share of GDP, per a 2023 report by the Department of pharmaceuticals

65-70%

Share of APIs imported, according to a FICCI report in 2022

5%

Market share of complex generics and biosimilars, according to industry estimates

DIAGNOSTICS

20%

Advanced diagnostics penetration in rural areas, per a 2022 NITI Aayog report

70-80%

Share of imports of equipment and reagents, per industry estimates

20%

The gap in availability of technicians and pathologists, per a 2021 report by IMA

programmes, early detection, and healthier choices.

Rural India mostly lacks basic diagnostic facilities, according to the Indian Council of Medical Research (ICMR) Rural Health Report 2023. Only 40% of PHCs are equipped, severely restricting access to X-rays and blood work.

Then, India's ratio of pathologists is only 0.7 per million, far below the WHO's recommended 3 per million. The WHO Report 2021 says the scarcity is particularly acute in rural areas.

"A key focus of the government should be on building local capabilities to deliver healthcare services even in the most remote regions, alongside the localisation of the healthcare value chain," says Raghuvarshi.

Technology is driving the growth of healthcare, but the National Health Resources Centre Report on Human Resources for Health 2021 sees a 20% deficit in skilled technicians and pathologists, which is worse in the rural areas of the country.

Despite these challenges, the prognosis is good.

Dr Om Manchanda, Managing Director, Dr Lal PathLabs, says artificial intelligence, machine learning and data analytics are revolutionising diagnostics. He anticipates increased emphasis on preventive healthcare, early detection, and personalised medicine, with telehealth's crucial role in accessibility.

Manchanda believes the government's commitment to Universal Health Care will create opportunities for public-private partnerships. "The industry is poised for substantial growth, aligned with our national health goals," says Manchanda. **BT**

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